

Flex – Senior Product Marketing Manager

I'm reaching out as someone who has spent the last several years building exactly the kind of product marketing, GTM and growth systems that teams like yours eventually need to scale with confidence.

My name is James. I'm a product marketing and growth operator with seven-plus years of hands-on experience working across B2B and SaaS companies in Africa, North America, and Europe. In that time, I've been the first or early marketing hire multiple times, responsible for taking ambiguous problems, shaping strategy, and then executing deeply across positioning, GTM, lifecycle, and growth.

I'm sharing this as context for how I think, the kind of work I do best, and the environments where I create the most impact. This is a snapshot of my operating philosophy as a product marketing and go-to-market practitioner, tailored to the kind of challenges Flex is solving as it builds a product marketing function for the first time, four years in, across eight product lines and past nine figures of annualized revenue.

How I think about the work I choose

I'm drawn to work that compounds. I care about roles where learning, ownership, and long-term thinking matter more than surface-level output. I'm motivated by understanding how products create value, how that value is communicated, and how systems are built to sustain growth over time without constant firefighting.

I consider myself a knowledge worker. I enjoy work that pushes me to understand new markets, customer behaviors, and product dynamics, then translate that understanding into frameworks and execution that teams can rely on. This curiosity is what led me to start Marketing In Action (marketinginaction.xyz), a platform where I document real-world product marketing and GTM systems so others can learn from applied examples, not theory.

I also value financial sustainability and strong professional networks, not as goals in themselves, but as enablers. They create the freedom to do meaningful work without constraint and to collaborate with people who raise the quality of thinking around me.

The experiences that shaped how I operate

Over the past seven-plus years, I've worked with early-to-growth stage companies across Africa, North America, and Europe, primarily in B2B, SaaS, and product-led environments. In many of these roles, I was the first or early marketing hire, responsible for building clarity where little existed, or at moments of transition.

My work has spanned product marketing, go-to-market strategy, demand generation, lifecycle systems, and growth experimentation. Across these engagements, I've contributed to over \$10M in qualified pipeline, supported more than 15 product launches, and helped teams achieve consistent, measurable improvements in acquisition, activation, conversion, and retention.

A recurring pattern in my career is being trusted to take ambiguous problems and turn them into structured systems. Whether it's repositioning a product, fixing a broken funnel, or designing a GTM motion from scratch, I'm most effective when I can combine strategy with hands-on execution.

One part of my background is less common for this role, and it matters for what you're hiring. Before I ran marketing, I carried a number. At Cecure Intelligence Limited I started as Sales Manager, then moved through Partnerships Manager and Head of Growth and Marketing to Chief Revenue Officer. I have sat on the call where the prospect says the competitor's name and there is nothing written down to say back. That experience is why I build enablement the way I do.

How documentation became leverage for me

Early in my career, I noticed that the fastest way to improve was to document everything. What worked, what failed, why decisions were made, and how outcomes changed. Over time, those notes turned into frameworks, templates, and playbooks that I reused across roles.

This habit eventually became Marketing In Action (newsletter.marketinginaction.xyz), an execution-first newsletter and community where I share applied product marketing, growth, and GTM insights. The goal has always been simple: make complex concepts easier to understand and easier to apply.

Documentation does more than preserve knowledge. It creates leverage. It allows teams to move faster, make better decisions, and avoid repeating mistakes. That belief still guides how I work today.

The type of problems I'm best suited to solve

I do my best work at the intersection of product, marketing, and growth. I don't see these as separate functions. I see them as parts of one system that should reinforce each other.

In Flex's context, that means:

- Extracting the story that already works rather than inventing a new one. A company does not reach nine figures by accident, so the narrative exists already, distributed across account executives and customer calls. The first job is pulling it out of call recordings and win/loss, writing it down, and making it survive contact with eight product lines.
- Settling what to say when a prospect names Ramp. I built the growth and product marketing function from zero at Bujeti (YC W23), a spend and expense management platform sold to finance teams, which is the same buyer and the same category, and generated 1,331 qualified leads in six months while doing it.
- Sequencing eighteen products into one argument. The lifecycle of a dollar, from what a business earns to what an owner spends, is a genuinely better organizing idea than a product catalog, and right now it lives in a blog post instead of on the homepage. I repositioned Reform from a form builder into a conversion-focused category product and lifted trial activation 34%, which was the same problem at a smaller scale.
- Building the handshake between Product and go-to-market so launches have a readiness bar rather than a date. At Reform I built a launch operating system that ran across web, email, in-app, and partner channels, and feature adoption rose 26% in ninety days.

I'm less interested in isolated campaigns and more interested in building systems that hold up as products and teams scale.

Why I value ownership and long-term thinking

In several roles, I've been responsible for building marketing functions from zero. That includes defining OKRs, choosing tools, setting budgets, establishing workflows, and deciding what not to do. Those experiences shaped how I think about ownership.

I'm most effective in environments where responsibility is clear and where marketing is expected to shape direction, not just execute requests. I care about outcomes, not just output, and I take pride in being accountable for the systems I build.

Flex describes small teams, real ownership, and a preference for execution over comfort. That is the environment where I have consistently done my best work, and it is the reason a first-product-marketer seat appeals to me more than a larger org where the narrative is already settled.

How I continue to evolve my craft

In addition to hands-on work, I invest heavily in continuous learning. I recently completed an MBA in Entrepreneurship and Innovation at Miva Open University (2026, CGPA 4.92/5.0), I hold a Product Marketing certification, and over 70 certifications across growth, analytics, product, AI, sales, and marketing operations.

More recently, I've been deeply involved in AI and GTM engineering, building automated research, content, and outbound systems using tools like Claude Code, ChatGPT, Clay, n8n, and Zapier. I document these workflows publicly, not as experiments in novelty, but as practical ways to improve how work gets done. Here's the YouTube playlist: https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PL9hp_79BJIXom0Q-gBy09yFp8ZTtv0WVG

In fact, I codified some of my core marketing skills into a github repo here: <https://github.com/realjaymes/marketingagentskills>

This mix of structured learning and applied experimentation keeps my thinking grounded and current.

A working hypothesis on Flex's competitive position

Rather than describe how I would approach this, I wrote a first draft of it. It is a competitive positioning brief with battlecards for Ramp, Brex, and [Bill.com](https://bill.com), and it is here: <https://jamespraise.xyz/work/flex/proof/>

Two things in it are worth flagging now.

The first is that Flex currently holds two opposite positions on its own competitive set. In March, Jared Thomas published "We Don't Sell Credit Here" and stated that Flex is not up against Brex, Ramp, Mercury or [Bill.com](https://bill.com). The role I'm writing about asks its next hire to own competitive positioning in a market where Ramp, Brex and [Bill.com](https://bill.com) fight for the same mental real estate. Both are right, at different altitudes, and a rep on a live call currently has to guess which one applies. Reconciling that in writing is probably week one.

The second is smaller and more immediately useful. Brex stopped being independent in April when Capital One closed its acquisition, and Flex's central argument is that owners are stuck with outdated banks. Nobody appears to have written the objection handling for that yet, and the window where it reads as a retreat rather than as a stronger balance sheet is open now.

Everything in the brief that would need your Apollo call data or real win/loss to stand up is marked as needing proof rather than guessed, because a battlecard with invented numbers gets used once and then never again.

One practical note. I'm based in Lagos and work with teams in the US and Europe on their hours, which is how I've run every engagement for the past several years. I know the posting is tagged for the US, and I'd rather raise it than have it sit unspoken.

I'm sharing this letter because the kind of role I'm interested in requires mutual clarity.

If Flex is looking for a Product Marketing Lead who treats marketing as a long-term system, operates comfortably in ambiguity, and cares deeply about product quality, narrative coherence, and sustainable growth, then this could be a strong fit.

If not, that clarity is still useful.

Thank you for taking the time to read this.

James

P.S. I've created a portfolio focused on this role at jamespraise.xyz/work/flex.